Sushree Monalisha

Strategic Design Management

Design strategist and researcher pursuing a Master's in Strategic Design Management at NID, with 3+ years of product development experience delivering 25+ collections for US retailers including Pottery Barn and West Elm. Skilled in user research, problem framing, and systems thinking, translating insights into product direction that balances user needs, feasibility, and commercial outcomes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Executive Product Designer — **June 2022 - June 2025**

Obeetee Pvt Ltd, Rugs & Carpets manufacturing and export

- Delivered 25+ rug and carpet collections for US retailers including Pottery Barn, West Elm, Rejuvenation, and GreenRow, translating buyer briefs and trends into collection strategy.
- Engineered new rug constructions and finishes through R&D, contributing to 2 new categories: 100% machine-washable and outdoor.
- Coordinated 5 teams (design, merchandising, sampling, production, quality) to take collections from concept to approval on schedule, balancing design intent, feasibility, and cost.
- Trained and mentored 3 design interns in trend research, CAD, and sampling

Design Intern — **Jan 2022 - April 2022**

Obeetee Pvt Ltd, Rugs & Carpets manufacturing and export

- Developed cushion and soft furnishing designs from trend research through buyer presentation and sampling.
- Designed 2 cushion collections for US buyers, with 2 products converted into confirmed orders.

Design Intern — **July 2021- Aug 2021**

FabOdisha, Handloom and Handicraft Startup

- Researched trends and market gaps in traditional handloom, generating 10+ product concepts that repositioned craft for broader customer segments and presenting them to the founder.

Marketing Intern — **April 2016- May 2016**

.inn, Student Housing Startup, Bhubaneswar

- Pitched 20 hostels on the benefits of listing on a student housing portal, onboarding 4 as partners; also supported branding and marketing strategy.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Women Handloom Cluster Development - Professional Project

Medinipur, West Bengal

- Worked with a cluster of 15 women artisans to develop 20+ market-oriented handloom styles in cushions and table mats for US buyers.
- Translated buyer requirements and market trends into designs the cluster could produce, bridging artisan skills and market demand.
- Achieved commercial validation, with 3 products converted to buyer orders.

Behavioral Analysis: Mid-Day Meal Program - College Project

Government Primary School, Gandhinagar, Gujarat

- Conducted 3 weeks of field observation and root cause analysis, identifying 3 recurring hygiene issues during school mid-day meals.
- Prototyped and tested behavior-change interventions, achieving 80% improvement in student hygiene behavior in simulated trials.

offspace: Personal Space on Campus- Service Design Project

NID, Gandhinagar, Gujarat

- Designed a campus pause service from student research; ran 2 live pilots, transitioning from free to paid with 91% show up rate and a 4.5/5 privacy rating.
- Developed a scale-up strategy, operating model and unit economics across 6 stakeholder groups.

EDUCATION

Master's in Strategic Design Management — **July 2025 to May 2027 (Expected)**

National Institute of Design, Gandhinagar

Bachelor's in Textile Design — **2018- 2022**

National Institute of Fahion Technology, Bhubaneswar



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SKILLS

Research: User Research, Field Research, Behavioral Analysis, Root Cause Analysis, Trend & Market Research, Insight Synthesis

Strategy: Design Strategy, Problem Framing, Systems Thinking, Opportunity Identification

Product Design: Human-Centered Design, Concept Development, Prototyping, Product Development, Product Portfolio Planning

Collaboration: Cross-functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, Buyer & Supplier Coordination, Team Mentoring

Software tools:

- Photoshop
- Microsoft Office
- InDesign
- Google workspace
- Illustrator
- Figma
- Miro

REWARDS

- President's Award (Rashtrapati Award) for social service, Scouts and Guides, 2010
- Governor's Award (Rajya Puraskar) for social service, Scouts and Guides, 2008
- Gold Medal for Excellence, Textile Design batch, NIFT Bhubaneswar, 2022

LANGUAGES

Odia (Native), Bengali (Fluent), Hindi (Fluent), English (Professional)